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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]
Organization: American Optometric Association

General Comment

Attached are comments from the American Optometric Association.

Attachments

AI framework RFI



AMERICAN OPTOMETRIC ASSOCIATION

March 15, 2025

Mr. Faisal D'Souza
NCO
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314

Dear Mr. D'Souza,

The American Optometric Association (AOA) appreciates the opportunity to provide feedback on the "Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan." AOA represents more than 49,000 doctors of optometry, optometric professionals, and optometry students. Doctors of optometry take a leading role in patient care with respect to eye health and vision care, as well as general health and wellbeing. As primary healthcare providers, doctors of optometry have extensive, ongoing training to examine, diagnose, treat, and manage ocular disorders, diseases, and injuries. They also play an important role in the management of systemic diseases with ocular manifestations including diabetes, hypertension, cardiovascular disease, autoimmune diseases, and neurologic disease.

Ensuring safety of the use of AI in healthcare is critical. When used appropriately, AI can be a tool to enhance the essential doctor patient relationship, which can aid in providing better health outcomes. Efforts should be made to ensure that AI is not used in a manner that puts that relationship at risk. As AI in healthcare expands, AOA believes that important criteria must be met:

- The value of AI in healthcare cannot be measured solely on the ability of the technology to accurately identify disease risk.
- To be truly valuable to patients, AI must be assessed based on whether patients identified with potential disease risk receive necessary care and follow-up.
- Companies using data sets to develop AI systems should consistently evaluate the data set to identify any gaps from particular populations.
- Models should be designed to account for data gaps, and where shortcomings in data exist, those models should be limited in use and those shortcomings should be clearly identified for potential users.
- Consideration should be given to whether models should be open source or that the training sources be required to be published.

In addition to carefully considering the clinical implications of AI in healthcare, we also believe more significant legislation and oversight is needed to identify and stop AI tools that create deepfakes. In the healthcare arena, we are increasingly seeing deepfakes of trusted health experts being used to spread misinformation. Reliance upon deepfake data could ultimately cause harm. We must see an increase in efforts to regulate deepfakes as well as increased law enforcement related to deepfakes in states where laws have already been passed.

The rising prominence of the use of AI in healthcare carries with it both hope and concern for its potential impact on patient outcomes. We commend the administration for seeking feedback on the action plan and for laying the groundwork for a national strategy on AI. Ongoing education will be critical for policymakers, regulators, patients and the healthcare workforce to understand both the limitations and potential uses of AI in healthcare. To assist in this effort, AOA recommends that an advisory group be created to develop regulatory guidance on the use of AI in healthcare broadly. We would welcome the opportunity to provide recommendations for doctors of optometry to be included on an advisory panel. If more information is needed, please contact Kara Webb [REDACTED]

Sincerely,

Steven Reed, O.D.
President, American Optometric Association